MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA AUTOMATION ENGINEER | CI/CD & PLATFORM ENGINEERING

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including the last two focused primarily on CI/CD pipelines, test environments and build tooling. Owns GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams and has built Helm-based ephemeral environments on a shared Kubernetes cluster. Personal hands-on experience with k3s, GitOps and Terraform complements professional platform-adjacent work. Currently studying for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam.

CORE SKILLS

CI/CD and automation: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm
Infrastructure and platforms: Kubernetes (namespace-level access; basic), k3s, Terraform (personal project), Argo CD, Linux
Monitoring and data: Grafana, Prometheus, Loki, PostgreSQL, SQL
Programming and scripting: Python, Bash, Java (test code)
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Other: Git, Ansible (basic), AWS (EC2 and S3 basics; personal learning)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes through parallel test jobs, dependency caching and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; reduced monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.
- Built merge-request ephemeral test environments using Docker Compose and later Helm charts deployed to the company's shared Kubernetes cluster. Environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data, and are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Built a test-results pipeline and Grafana dashboards to show flaky tests by team.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding.
- Wrote the internal guide to CI pipelines used in team onboarding; mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw 2019–2021

- Performed manual and automated testing of web and mobile applications for client projects.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal 2024–2025

- Built a three-node k3s cluster on Raspberry Pi 5 devices, with applications deployed from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform in a personal account; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health 2023–2024

- Delivered short-lived environments for each merge request, with the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data deployed through GitLab CI and Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Automated environment cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity, enabling QA and product reviews before merge and end-to-end testing against each environment.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health 2022

- Profiled pipelines across three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and split end-to-end tests into a separate stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%.

Flaky Test Dashboard | Odrava Health 2023

- Collected CI test results in PostgreSQL and created Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests by team.
- Helped teams identify and address leading flaky-test issues; the flaky rate fell from 7% to below 1%.

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology 2018

CERTIFICATION AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam preparation; exam booked for January 2027 (not yet certified)

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)